



able to provide support subtitles; we all do love those foreign-language films, don't we? Other extras in a player such as support for DTS (Digital Theatre Systems, an audio format similar to Dolby Digital 5.1) and an MPEG splitter would always be welcome.

None of these should, however, come at the expense of size. So do we have players that fit the bill? The open source public license has made it easy to find players that will happily gobble up anything thrown at them. We've picked the choicest few for you. A couple of them are must-haves, and might easily replace your existing media player.

4.2.1 VLC Media Player

This player started life as the cross-platform client for the VideoLAN open source video streaming server solution. Since then it has matured into the versatile player of choice for almost everyone who knows his video from his audio. This robust, never-say-die player plays just about anything you throw at it. Sometimes, though, the video is a little garbled, but there is some video output - not just visualisations as in Windows Media Player.